



YOU ARE **23 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
118 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

There is no light in the uterus, but 3D ultrasound is designed to produce highlights and shadows to give the same effect as if you shone a flashlight into the uterus. Now your baby may be holding her hands flexed into a fist.

“From this point onward, your baby is considered “viable” and would receive life-saving treatment were they born early.”

Week 24 is considered the age of viability for your baby, and therefore an important pregnancy milestone. Like many women, you may feel relieved to get past this point.

If you went into labor and delivered your baby before this week, they would be unlikely to survive and you would be considered to have had a miscarriage. After 24 weeks, the doctors will do everything they can to save the baby, although babies delivered this early have an increased risk of long-term disability.

The more advanced you are in your pregnancy before you deliver, the less likely it is that your baby will face the problems associated with being born prematurely.

NEONATAL INTENSIVE CARE UNITS

Babies who are born prematurely, or newborns who are sick, will receive specialized around-the-clock care in a [neonatal intensive care](#) unit (NICU). The earlier the baby is born, the more chance there is of complications, such as infections, occurring. If your baby is born several weeks prematurely, they may need to be cared for in a level 3 NICU—this may not be in the hospital where they were born. Your baby may be put in an incubator with monitors attached and receive oxygen through a special ventilator. Some of the equipment looks very frightening, but remember it is there to help them stay warm and nourished and improve their health.

The staff will readily explain what is going on, and they will be eager for you to be involved as closely as possible in your baby's care and encourage bonding.